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General Knowledge

Static GK

STUDY NOTES

Books & Authors - National

IMPORTANT BOOKS AND AUTHORS - NATIONAL

Book Title	Author	Year	Description
The God of Small Things	Arundhati Roy	**1997**	Booker Prize-winning novel exploring complex relationships, social issues, and cultural dynamics in Kerala.
Malgudi Days	R.K. Narayan	**1943**	Collection of short stories set in the fictional town of Malgudi, depicting the lives and values of common Indian characters.
Train to Pakistan	Khushwant Singh	**1956**	Set during the 1947 Partition, it captures the trauma and human impact of the separation of India and Pakistan.
Clear Light of Day	Anita Desai	**1980**	Explores family dynamics and memory in post-partition India, depicting complex sibling relationships.
The Shadow Lines	Amitav Ghosh	**1988**	An interconnected family saga that addresses themes of nationalism, cultural dislocation, and memory across India and Bangladesh.
The Namesake	Jhumpa Lahiri	**2003**	Follows an immigrant family from Bengal as they navigate identity and belonging in America.
Whereabouts		**2018**	a novel about a lonely, unnamed woman in Italy who is in the middle of her life's journey
Midnight's Children	Salman Rushdie	**1981**	A magical realist tale of India's post-independence years, following the lives of children born at the exact moment of India's freedom.

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The Immortals of Meluha	Amish Tripathi	**2010**	The first book in the Shiva Trilogy, blending mythology and fiction, features Shiva as the protagonist.
The Secret of the Nagas		**2011**	The second book in the Shiva Trilogy, continues Shiva's journey in an epic tale of mystery and mythology.
The Oath of the Vayuputras		**2013**	The concluding book of the Shiva Trilogy, wrapping up the saga with a blend of mythology and philosophy.
Scion of Ikshvaku		**2015**	The first book in the Ram Chandra Series, reimagining the story of Lord Ram with a historical touch.
Sita: Warrior of Mithila		**2017**	The second book in the Ram Chandra Series, telling the story of Sita from a warrior's perspective.
Raavan: Enemy of Aryavarta		**2019**	A reimagined tale of the character of Raavan, exploring his journey from a misunderstood villain to a hero.
Wise and Otherwise	Sudha Murthy	**2002**	A collection of short stories reflecting Sudha Murthy's insights on human nature and life's lessons.
The Day I Stopped Drinking Milk		**2006**	A collection of heartwarming and inspiring short stories based on everyday life experiences.
The Mother I Never Knew		**2012**	A touching tale about a woman's search for the truth about her mother's past.
Three Thousand Stitches		**2013**	A collection of stories focusing on themes of life, kindness, and the people Murthy has met in her charitable work.
The Magic of the Lost Temple		**2016**	A children's novel that takes young readers on an adventure to find a

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			hidden temple.
Rusty: The Boy from the Hills	Ruskin Bond	**1990**	The first book in the Rusty Series depicts the life of a young boy named Rusty living in the hills.
The Room on the Roof		**1956**	Ruskin Bond's first novel focuses on the journey of a teenage boy in the Indian hills and his quest for belonging.
Tales of Fosterganj		**2008**	A collection of stories set in the Himalayan town of Fosterganj, offering insights into the simple life of its inhabitants.
The Blue Umbrella		**2002**	A short story about a girl and her magical blue umbrella, capturing innocence and the beauty of life in the hills.
A Flight of Pigeons		**1980**	A historical novel set during the Indian Rebellion of 1857, exploring the tumultuous events through the eyes of a young girl.
Delhi Is Not Far		**1994**	A novel set in a small town, capturing the lives of its inhabitants, their dreams, and their connection to Delhi.
Narcopolis	Jeet Thayil	**2012**	Explores the opium dens and the underground culture of 1970s Bombay, examining addiction, love, and survival.
The Sari Shop	Rupa Bajwa	**2004**	Follows the life of a sari shop worker in Amritsar, reflecting on class disparity, aspirations, and personal discovery.
So Many Hungers!	Bhabani Bhattachary a	**1947**	A novel about India's struggle for independence and the Bengal famine, illustrating social inequality and poverty.

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Rich Like Us	Nayantara Sahgal	**1985**	A political novel set during the Emergency, capturing the impact of power, corruption, and social change in India.
River of Fire (Aag Ka Dariya)	Qurratulain Hyder	**1959**	Spanning 2,500 years, this epic novel covers multiple eras in Indian history, addressing themes of identity, love, and culture.
The Twentieth Wife	Indu Sundaresan	**2002**	Historical novel about the life of Mehrunnisa, the empress and wife of Emperor Jahangir, exploring the Mughal era.
Byomkesh Bakshi Stories	Sharadindu Bandyopadhyay	**1932**	Detective series following Byomkesh, a Bengali sleuth, solving cases in 20th-century India, filled with suspense and wit.
The Zoya Factor	Anuja Chauhan	**2008**	Romantic comedy about a girl who becomes the lucky mascot for the Indian cricket team, blending humor with sports culture.
A House for Mr Biswas	V.S. Naipaul	**1961**	Follows the life of an Indo-Trinidadian man struggling to build a home, reflecting themes of identity and postcolonial legacy.
Godan	Premchand	**1936**	Classic Hindi novel portraying the plight of poor farmers, exploring themes of poverty, exploitation, and social structure.
The House with a Thousand Stories	Aruni Kashyap	**2013**	Set in Assam, this novel explores political turmoil, family bonds, and secrets in a traditional Assamese household.

Born Confused	Tanuja Desai Hidier	**2002**	A coming-of-age story about an Indian-American girl, balancing her cultural heritage with life in the United States.
Where the River Parts	Radhika Swarup	**2016**	A love story set against the backdrop of Partition, depicting separation, memory, and resilience.
Sister of My Heart	Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni	**1999**	Follows the bond between two cousins in Kolkata, exploring family expectations, friendship, and love.
Hangwoman	K.R. Meera	**2012**	A story of a woman working as a hangwoman in Kolkata, addressing gender roles, tradition, and individual struggle.
The Great Indian Novel	Shashi Tharoor	**1989**	A satirical novel that reimagines the Mahabharata within the context of modern Indian politics, blending mythology with humour.
The Alchemy oDesire	Tarun Tejpal	**2005**	A tale of love, passion, and relationships, exploring the deep emotions between a writer and his wife in a small Indian town.
When I Hit You	Meena Kandasamy	**2017**	A semi-autobiographical novel about domestic abuse, addressing power, freedom, and survival within the context of a marriage.
The Reluctant Detective	Richa Jha	**2011**	Light-hearted mystery novel about a housewife-turned-detective in Mumbai, blending comedy with suspense.
The Parcel	Anosh Irani	**2016**	Follows the life of a transgender woman in Mumbai's red-light district, highlighting marginalized voices and

			struggles.
Serious Men	Manu Joseph	**2010**	A satire on the aspirations of lower-c

Books and authors of sports personalities:

Book Title	Author	Year	Description
Playing It My Way	Sachin Tendulkar	**2014**	Autobiography of the legendary Indian cricketer, offering insights into his career and philosophy.
My Life in Football	Kevin Keegan	**2007**	Memoir of the English footballer, covering his career and insights into football in England.
The Test of My Life	Yuvraj Singh	**2013**	Yuvraj's journey through cricket and his battle with cancer, highlight his resilience.
I Am No Messiah	M.S. Dhoni	**2013**	Autobiography of M.S. Dhoni, detailing his rise as a cricketer and captain of India.
A Bend in the Road	Greg Chappell	**2008**	Account of Greg Chappell's cricket career and leadership.
Rafa: My Story	Rafael Nadal	**2011**	Autobiography of tennis legend Rafael Nadal, chronicling his journey to becoming a top athlete.
The Inner Game of Tennis	W. Timothy Gallwey	**1974**	Focuses on the mental aspects of tennis and sports performance.
The Autobiography of an Unknown Cricketer	R.N. Ramaswamy	**2001**	Reflects on Ramaswamy's journey in cricket, offering a unique perspective on the sport.

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Gold Rush	Usain Bolt	**2010**	Autobiography of sprint legend Usain Bolt, sharing his Olympic journey and passion for athletics.
Open	Andre Agassi	**2009**	A personal account of tennis star Andre Agassi's career and struggles in the world of sports.
Unbreakable	Mary Kom	**2013**	The inspiring story of Indian boxer Mary Kom's rise and struggles in the world of boxing.
A Life in Sport	Sunil Gavaskar	**2011**	Biography of cricket legend Sunil Gavaskar, detailing his career and views on cricket's evolution.
When Breath Becomes Air	Paul Kalanithi	**2016**	Memoir of a neurosurgeon who confronts his own terminal cancer diagnosis, offering deep insights.

National Award-Winning Books

Book Name	Author	Accolade
Mirage and Other Stories	Damodar Mauzo	57th Jnanpith Award (2022)
Things to Leave Behind (novel)	Namita Gokhale	Sahitya Akademi Award (English, 2021)
Kabita (poem)	Nilmani Phookan Jr	56th Jnanpith Award (2021)
When God Is a Traveler (poem)	Arundhathi Subramaniam	Sahitya Akademi Award (English, 2020)
Samrat Ashok (Play)	Daya Prakash Sinha	Sahitya Akademi Award (Hindi, 2021)

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An Era of Darkness (non-fiction)	Shashi Tharoor	Sahitya Akademi Award (English, 2019)
Tokri Mein Digant 'Their Gatha' : 2014 (Poetry)	Anamika	Sahitya Akademi Award (Hindi, 2020)
Tell Her Everything	Mirza Waheed	The Hindu Literary Prize (Fiction, 2019)

Non-Fiction Books

Book Name	Author	Accolade
Karmayodha Granth	Amit Shah	**2020**
Unstoppable: My Life So Far	Maria Sharapova	**2017**
Every Vote Counts – The Story of India's Elections	Navin Chawla	**2019**
Undaunted: Saving the Idea of India	P.Chidambaram	**2014**
Pajamas are Forgiving	Twinkle Khanna	**2018**
India Unbound	Gurcharan Das	**2000**
Business Legends	Gita Piramal	**1998**
The Idea of India	Sunil Khilnani	**1997**
Breakout Nations: In Pursuit of the Next Economic Miracles	Ruchir Sharma	**2012**

Important books of 2024

Book Name	Author(s) Name
Ek Samandar, Mere Andar	Sanjeev Joshi
Political History of Assam (1947-1971) – Volume 1	Dr. Rajen Saikia
Smritivan: An Unparalleled Apotheosis of Commemoration to 2001 Victims of Gujarat Earthquake	Gujarat State Disaster Management Authority
Assam's Braveheart – Lachit Barphukan	Arup Kumar Dutta
Fertilising the Future: Bharat's March Towards Fertiliser Self-Sufficiency	Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya
An Uncommon Love: The Early Life of Sudha and Narayana Murthy	Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
Gandhi: A Life in Three Campaigns	M.J. Akbar and K Natwar Singh
Modi: Energising A Green Future	R.K. Pachnanda, Bibek Debroy, Anirban Ganguly, and Uttam Kumar Sinha
Four Stars of Destiny	General Manoj Mukund Naravane
Sanskriti ke Ayaam	Manorama Mishra
Maha Kavithai	Vairamuthu
Ram Mandir Rashtra Mandir Ek Sajhi Virast	Geeta Singh and Arif Khan Bharti
Knife: Meditations After an Attempted Murder	Salman Rushdie
Unashamed: Notes From the Diary of a Sex Therapist	Neha Bhat

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The Hill of Enchantment: The Story of My Life as a Writer	Ruskin Bond
Acts of God	Kanan Gill
Ananda: A journey into India's ancient complex relationship with cannabis	Karan Madhok
The Lost Treasure of Azad Hind Fauj	Piyush Rohankar
Goagram	Bina Nayak
Shakchunni	Arnab Ray
The Cooking of Books: A Literary Memoir	Ramachandra Guha
The Idolaters	Manu S Pillai
The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World	William Dalrymple